

Rosendal Equestrian Experiences (REE)
Premium Startup Concept Note

Document version: 2.0 (Professional Edition)

Date: May 26, 2026

Location: Rosendal, Free State, South Africa

1) Executive Concept

Rosendal Equestrian Experiences (REE) is a professionally positioned, small-scale tourism startup that delivers curated horseback experiences for weekend visitors, couples, and families in Rosendal.

The concept is intentionally right-sized for a small town: lean launch costs, premium service standards, strict safety governance, and phased growth only after performance proof.

Positioning statement:

?A boutique countryside riding experience in Rosendal: safe, memorable, and professionally run.?

2) The Market Opportunity (Small Town, Smart Model)

Rosendal's scale requires a visitor-led model rather than local-volume dependence.

REE is built around:

Weekend tourism demand (Fri-Sun concentration)

Accommodation-linked referrals (guesthouses/lodges/retreats)

Experience-first spend behavior (tourists seeking memorable activities)

This creates a realistic opportunity for a niche operator that focuses on quality over volume.

3) Core Offering Portfolio

Launch products (Phase 1)

Scenic Trail Ride (60 minutes)

Guided route designed for relaxed leisure riders.

Sunset Signature Ride (75-90 minutes)

Premium golden-hour experience with curated stop.

Pony Discovery Ride (10-15 minutes)

Family-focused product for younger children.

Private Couple Experience (by booking)

Premium upsell for anniversaries/special occasions.

4) Premium Service Standards

REE will differentiate through disciplined execution:

Structured guest communication from booking to post-ride

Clean rider onboarding and pre-ride briefings

Professional guide conduct and experience narration
Route consistency and punctual start times
Post-ride feedback capture for quality assurance

5) Pricing Architecture (Professional, Reasonable)
Recommended launch pricing (conservative but premium-leaning):

Pony Discovery Ride: R120?R180
Scenic Trail Ride (60m): R380?R520 per person
Sunset Signature Ride: R550?R750 per person
Private Couple Experience: R1,300?R1,900 per booking

Pricing is structured to remain accessible while supporting sustainable margins.

6) Startup Funding Requirement
Total startup ask: R280,000

Use of funds (disciplined split)
28% Safety gear, tack, and launch setup
20% Horse care reserve (feed, vet, farrier)
15% Insurance and compliance
15% Marketing, content, and booking setup
12% Working capital protection
10% Route readiness and signage

The funding structure is intentionally modest to reduce investor risk while enabling professional launch quality.

7) Go-to-Market Model
Primary channel: Partner properties
Guesthouses and retreats become referral partners.
Clear booking workflow and service reliability build partner confidence.

Secondary channels:
Google Business Profile
WhatsApp bookings
Instagram/Facebook visual storytelling

This blended channel model supports consistent discovery and conversion.

8) Safety, Legal, and Welfare Governance
REE will operate with non-negotiable controls:
Signed indemnity documentation
Rider suitability screening

- Mandatory pre-ride safety briefing
- Incident response process
- Public liability cover
- Horse welfare logs and rest-cycle controls
- Weather cancellation/reschedule policy

9) Execution Roadmap (First 12 Months)

Months 1?2: Foundation

- Finalize SOPs, forms, and insurance
- Onboard launch accommodation partners
- Soft-launch limited slots

Months 3?6: Stabilization

- Improve occupancy on weekend slots
- Track conversion by partner and product
- Adjust pricing only from real booking data

Months 7?12: Optimization

- Improve repeat bookings and referrals
- Add one premium add-on only if contribution margins remain healthy
- Prepare year-2 growth plan from evidence

10) Investor Value Proposition

REE offers a fundable profile for small-capital investors:

- Modest startup ask
- Clear cost controls
- Defined risk management
- Professional service differentiation
- Phased expansion discipline

Bottom line: REE is a premium-quality, small-town startup concept designed for practical execution and responsible growth.